



IVAN · FREE

What I learned building with AI.

Seven things I wish someone had told me. Then the Claude Code facts nobody explains: what it costs, why it forgets, why usage runs out, and how to spend less.

Seven things I wish someone had told me.

1

One brain, not ten apps.

Every tool you add is another place your business lives. Put it in one place that knows all of it.

2

It forgets. Write it down.

A chat has no memory past the chat. What matters lives in a file it reads every time it starts, or it is gone by tomorrow.

3

Make it ask before it acts.

Sending, spending, deleting, posting. Not a promise in a prompt: a lock it cannot get past without your yes.

4

A confident answer is not a true answer.

Ask for the receipt: the file, the number, the command that produced it. If it cannot show one, it guessed.

And three more.

5

Plan first. Then build.

Anything with more than three steps gets a plan you read before it types. Going back is the expensive part.

6

Let it say what it costs before it spends.

Credits, tokens, money. The number first, then the yes. A brain that spends quietly is not yours.

7

One recommendation, not a menu.

When it hands you five options, it has not done the thinking. Ask for the one it would pick and why.

Everything on this page is how my own brain runs today. None of it needs code to understand, and all of it is what a session with me sets up for you.

What it costs, and what you get.

Free: no Claude Code.

The free plan is the chat only. The brain needs Claude Code, which starts at Pro.

Pro: 20 USD a month.

17 on a yearly plan. Claude Code is included, with at least five times the usage of Free in each five-hour window. This is where most people should start.

Max: from 100 USD a month.

Five or twenty times the usage of Pro. Worth it only once Pro actually runs out on you, not before.

The limit is shared.

Chat and Claude Code draw from the same allowance. When it runs out you wait for the reset, upgrade, or turn on usage credits at standard rates.

Prices from claude.com/pricing, September 2026. They change; the page is the truth.

Why it forgets, and why usage runs out.

It sends the whole conversation every time.

Each message carries everything said before it. After a long day in one chat, a one-line question costs as much as the whole day.

The window has an end.

The newest models hold about a million tokens, roughly 750,000 words. Near the end, Claude Code squeezes the older part into a summary, and details go missing there.

After an hour away, it re-reads everything.

Your first message after a break costs the whole history again. Start fresh after lunch instead of continuing.

Idle is not free.

A scheduled task that fires while you are away sends the full context each time.

The fix is not a bigger plan. It is a brain that keeps what matters in files and starts each day clean.

Eight ways to spend less.

`/clear`

Start fresh between unrelated tasks. Stale context costs on every message after it.

`/compact + what to keep`

When a chat gets long, tell it what to keep in the summary.

`/usage`

See what is eating your allowance: long context, cache misses, a tool you forgot to switch off.

`/model sonnet`

Sonnet for daily work. The bigger models only for hard reasoning.

`/effort`

Lower the thinking level for simple tasks. Thinking is billed too.

`Shift+Tab, plan mode`

For anything big, read its plan before it types. Rework is the expensive part.

`Be specific`

"Fix the login" beats "improve this". Vague asks make it read everything.

`/mcp`

Switch off connected tools you do not use. Each one left on costs a little every message.

PART THREE

A bare install, and a brain built for you.

ALONE

It forgets by tomorrow.

You explain the business again in every chat.

It can send, spend or delete when you were not looking.

You find out what it did when something breaks.

Every new job starts from a blank screen.

You hope it is right.

WITH THE BRAIN

It reads who you are and what happened yesterday, every time it starts.

It already knows the menu, the bookings, the suppliers, the prices.

It stops and asks you first. A lock, not a promise.

It writes its own day down. You read it with your coffee.

The skills for your jobs are installed the day it wakes.

It shows the receipt, or it says it does not know.

The right column is what one session with me sets up, from your answers, in an afternoon. Then it is yours.

If it sounds right for your business, message me.

Tell me what you run. That is all it takes to begin.

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